

Psalms 65

Praise Waiteth for Thee

Praise waiteth for thee, O God, in Zion

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise waiteth for thee, O God, in Zion: and unto thee shall the vow be performed.
- 2 O thou that hearest prayer, unto thee shall all flesh come.
- 3 Iniquities prevail against me: as for our transgressions, thou shalt purge them away.
- 4 Blessed is the man whom thou choosest, and causest to approach unto thee, that he may dwell in thy courts: we shall be satisfied with the goodness of thy house, even of thy holy temple.
- 5 By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us, O God of our salvation; who art the confidence of all the ends of the earth, and of them that are afar off upon the sea:
- 6 Which by his strength setteth fast the mountains; being girded with power:
- 7 Which stilleth the noise of the seas, the noise of their waves, and the tumult of the people.
- 8 They also that dwell in the uttermost parts are afraid at thy tokens: thou makest the outgoings of the morning and evening to rejoice.
- 9 Thou visitest the earth, and waterest it: thou greatly enrichest it with the river of God, which is full of water: thou preparest them corn, when thou hast so provided for it.
- 10 Thou waterest the ridges thereof abundantly: thou settlest the furrows thereof: thou makest it soft with showers: thou blessest the springing thereof.
- 11 Thou crownest the year with thy goodness; and thy paths drop fatness.
- 12 They drop upon the pastures of the wilderness: and the little hills rejoice on every side.
- 13 The pastures are clothed with flocks; the valleys also are covered over with corn; they shout for joy, they also sing.

2 · CONTEXT

A harvest and covenant psalm blending forgiveness of sin, God's power over creation, and His generous provision through rain and harvest. Henry treats it as moving from personal and national atonement (1–4) to cosmic sovereignty (5–8) to agricultural blessing (9–13), showing that the God who forgives is the same God who governs nature and feeds nations.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

"Praise waiteth for thee, O God, in Zion... thou that hearest prayer... iniquities prevail against me: as for our transgressions, thou shalt purge them away." Access to God's courts is framed as pure gift—blessed is the one God chooses and satisfies with the goodness of His house.

Verse 5-8

"By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us, O God of our salvation... Who stilleth the noise of the seas... the outgoings of the morning and evening to rejoice." Awe-inspiring acts of judgment and creation-control cause even the ends of the earth to fear and the farthest dawn and dusk to rejoice.

Verse 9-13

"Thou visitest the earth, and waterest it... thou preparest them corn... the pastures are clothed with flocks; the valleys also are covered over with corn: they shout for joy, they also sing." Agricultural abundance is described as God's personal visitation and generosity, evoking a creation bursting into song at His care.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

The same God who forgives sin and answers prayer in Zion also governs raging seas and tumultuous peoples, and personally visits the earth to water it and clothe valleys with grain—forgiveness, sovereignty, and provision are one seamless expression of His character.

Application for life today.

Let corporate worship be something you actively anticipate, not merely attend. When overwhelmed by chaotic circumstances, remember the same God who stills nations governs your storm. Notice ordinary provision—weather, harvest, daily bread—as personal divine visitation worthy of the joyful response described in verse 13.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does linking forgiveness of sin (vv. 3–4) with God's rule over nature (vv. 5–8) deepen your view of His character?
2. Where do you need to trust the God who "stilleth the noise of the seas" amid a current chaotic situation?
3. What ordinary provision in your life could you receive today as God's personal "visitation," as in verses 9–13?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).